Himaayah Schools
MADRASAH

FREE GUIDE

نَضَّرَ اللَّهُ امْرَأً سَمِعَ مِنَّا حَدِيثًا فَحَفِظَهُ

"May Allah brighten the face of a person who hears a ḥadīth from us and memorises it." (Abū Dāwūd 3660

The Forty Ḥadīth

Al-Arbaʿīn an-Nawawiyyah: all 42 ḥadīth in Arabic, with a clear translation, the source and the key lessons.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Imām Yaḥyā ibn Sharaf an-Nawawī (631–676 AH), the great scholar of Damascus, gathered forty-two ḥadīth that together cover the foundations of the religion: belief, worship, character, dealings with people and the purification of the heart. Scholars said each of them is "one of the pillars upon which the religion turns". For more than seven centuries, Muslims have memorised this collection first, before any other book of ḥadīth.

This booklet gives every ḥadīth in **Arabic**, with a clear **English translation** written for Himaayah, its **source**, and the **key lessons** to act on. It is a companion to the Himaayah **Ḥadīth Bootcamp**, where each ḥadīth is explained in recorded lessons, with quizzes and a certificate.

> نَضَّرَ اللَّهُ امْرَأً سَمِعَ مِنَّا حَدِيثًا فَحَفِظَهُ حَتَّى يُبَلِّغَهُ
>
> **"May Allah brighten the face of a person who hears a ḥadīth from us, memorises it and conveys it to others."**
>
> Abū Dāwūd (3660), at-Tirmidhī (2656).

How to use this booklet

Take **one ḥadīth a week**: read the Arabic and the translation every day, memorise the words of the Prophet ﷺ, and act on one lesson.

Tick it off in the **tracker** at the end when you can recite it to a teacher or parent.

In forty-two weeks, less than a year, you will carry the foundations of the religion in your heart.

Contents The forty-two ḥadīth

No.	Ḥadīth	No.	Ḥadīth
1	Actions are by intentions	22	The obligations that lead to Paradise
2	Islām, īmān and iḥsān: the ḥadīth of Jibrīl	23	Purity is half of faith
3	The five pillars of Islām	24	The prohibition of injustice
4	Creation in the womb and the decree	25	Every good deed is charity
5	Rejecting innovation in the religion	26	Charity for every joint
6	The lawful, the unlawful and the doubtful	27	Righteousness and sin
7	The religion is sincere advice	28	Hold fast to the Sunnah
8	The sanctity of a Muslim	29	The deeds that lead to Paradise, and the tongue
9	Do what you can, avoid what is forbidden	30	The limits set by Allah
10	Allah is pure and accepts only what is pure	31	Be detached from the world
11	Leave what makes you doubt	32	No harm and no reciprocating harm
12	Leaving what does not concern you	33	The burden of proof
13	Love for your brother what you love for yourself	34	Changing what is wrong
14	The sanctity of a Muslim's life	35	The brotherhood of Muslims
15	Speak good, honour your neighbour and guest	36	Relieving others and seeking knowledge
16	Do not become angry	37	How good and bad deeds are recorded
17	Excellence in everything	38	The friends of Allah
18	Taqwā wherever you are	39	Mistakes, forgetfulness and coercion
19	Be mindful of Allah, He will protect you	40	Be in this world like a stranger
20	Modesty (ḥayāʾ)	41	Desires that follow the Revelation
21	Say: I believe in Allah, then be steadfast	42	The vastness of Allah's forgiveness

Ḥadīth 1 · Actions are by intentions

عَنْ أَمِيرِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَبِي حَفْصٍ عُمَرَ بْنِ الْخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ، وَإِنَّمَا لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مَا نَوَى، فَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ، وَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ لِدُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوْ امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى مَا هَاجَرَ إِلَيْهِ

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: “Actions are only by intentions, and every person will have only what he intended. So whoever emigrated for Allah and His Messenger, his emigration is for Allah and His Messenger; and whoever emigrated for some worldly thing he wants to gain, or a woman he wants to marry, his emigration is for what he emigrated for.”

Narrated by ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb. Al-Bukhārī (1) and Muslim (1907).

- Allah judges a deed by the intention behind it, so the same outward action can be worship or nothing at all.
- An intention lives in the heart. You do not need to say it aloud for it to count.
- Renew your intention before study, prayer and work, and check it again in the middle of a deed.

Ḥadīth 2 · Islām, īmān and iḥsān: the ḥadīth of Jibrīl

عَنْ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَيْضًا قَالَ: بَيْنَمَا نَحْنُ جُلُوسٌ عِنْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ، إِذْ طَلَعَ عَلَيْنَا رَجُلٌ شَدِيدُ بَيَاضِ الثِّيَابِ، شَدِيدُ سَوَادِ الشَّعْرِ، لَا يُرَى عَلَيْهِ أَثَرُ السَّفَرِ، وَلَا يَعْرِفُهُ مِنَّا أَحَدٌ. حَتَّى جَلَسَ إِلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ. فَأَسْنَدَ رُكْبَتَيْهِ إِلَى رُكْبَتَيْهِ، وَوَضَعَ كَفَّيْهِ عَلَى فَخِذَيْهِ،
وَقَالَ: يَا مُحَمَّدُ أَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ الْإِسْلَامِ.
فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ الْإِسْلَامُ أَنْ تَشْهَدَ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَتُقِيمَ الصَّلَاةَ، وَتُؤْتِيَ الزَّكَاةَ، وَتَصُومَ رَمَضَانَ، وَتَحُجَّ الْبَيْتَ إِنِ اسْتَطَعْتَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا.
قَالَ: صَدَقْتَ. فَعَجِبْنَا لَهُ يَسْأَلُهُ وَيُصَدِّقُهُ!
قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ الْإِيمَانِ.
قَالَ: أَنْ تُؤْمِنَ بِاللَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَكُتُبِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ، وَتُؤْمِنَ بِالْقَدَرِ خَيْرِهِ وَشَرِّهِ.

قَالَ: صَدَقْت. قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنْ الْإِحْسَانِ.
قَالَ: أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّك تَرَاهُ، فَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَرَاهُ فَإِنَّهُ يَرَاك.
قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنْ السَّاعَةِ. قَالَ: مَا الْمَسْئُولُ عَنْهَا بِأَعْلَمَ مِنْ السَّائِلِ.
قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنْ أَمَارَاتِهَا؟ قَالَ: أَنْ تَلِدَ الْأَمَةُ رَبَّتَهَا، وَأَنْ تَرَى الْحُفَاةَ الْعُرَاةَ الْعَالَةَ رِعَاءَ الشَّاءِ يَتَطَاوَلُونَ فِي الْبُنْيَانِ. ثُمَّ انْطَلَقَ، فَلَبِثْتُ مَلِيًّا،
ثُمَّ قَالَ: يَا عُمَرُ أَتَدْرِي مَنْ السَّائِلُ؟
قُلْتُ: اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ.
قَالَ: فَإِنَّهُ جِبْرِيلُ أَتَاكُمْ يُعَلِّمُكُمْ دِينَكُمْ

One day, while we were sitting with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, a man appeared before us with very white clothes and very black hair. No sign of travel could be seen on him, and none of us knew him. He sat down facing the Prophet ﷺ, rested his knees against his knees, placed his palms on his thighs and said: “O Muḥammad, tell me about Islām.” The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Islām is that you testify that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah, establish the prayer, pay the zakāh, fast Ramaḍān, and perform Ḥajj to the House if you are able to.” He said: “You have spoken truly.” We were amazed that he asked him and then confirmed his answer. He said: “Tell me about īmān.” He said: “That you believe in Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers and the Last Day, and that you believe in the decree, its good and its bad.” He said: “You have spoken truly. Tell me about iḥsān.” He said: “That you worship Allah as though you see Him, and if you do not see Him, He certainly sees you.” He said: “Tell me about the Hour.” He said: “The one asked about it knows no more than the one asking.” He said: “Then tell me about its signs.” He said: “That the slave-woman gives birth to her mistress, and that you see barefoot, unclothed, destitute shepherds competing in building tall buildings.” Then he left, and I stayed a while. Then he said: “O ʿUmar, do you know who the questioner was?” I said: “Allah and His Messenger know best.” He said: “That was Jibrīl. He came to teach you your religion.”

Narrated by ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb. Muslim (8).

- The religion has three levels: islām (outward practice), īmān (inner belief) and iḥsān (worshipping with full awareness of Allah).
- Jibrīl taught the Companions by asking questions, showing that good questions are a way of learning.
- A scholar should say “I do not know” when he does not know: even the Prophet ﷺ did not know when the Hour will come.

Ḥadīth 3 · The five pillars of Islām

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عُمَرَ بْنِ الْخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: بُنِيَ الْإِسْلَامُ عَلَى خَمْسٍ: شَهَادَةِ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَإِقَامِ الصَّلَاةِ، وَإِيتَاءِ الزَّكَاةِ، وَحَجِّ الْبَيْتِ، وَصَوْمِ رَمَضَانَ

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: "Islām is built on five: testifying that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing the prayer, paying the zakāh, Ḥajj to the House, and fasting Ramaḍān."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar. Al-Bukhārī (8) and Muslim (16).

- Islām is like a building, and these five are its pillars. Without them the building cannot stand.
- The shahādah comes first: every other act is built on sincere belief in Allah and following His Messenger ﷺ.
- The pillars combine the body (prayer, fasting), wealth (zakāh) and both together (Ḥajj).

Ḥadīth 4 · Creation in the womb and the decree

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ -وَهُوَ الصَّادِقُ الْمَصْدُوقُ-: إِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ يُجْمَعُ خَلْقُهُ فِي بَطْنِ أُمِّهِ أَرْبَعِينَ يَوْمًا نُطْفَةً، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ عَلَقَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ مُضْغَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يُرْسَلُ إِلَيْهِ الْمَلَكُ فَيَنْفُخُ فِيهِ الرُّوحَ، وَيُؤْمَرُ بِأَرْبَعِ كَلِمَاتٍ: بِكَتْبِ رِزْقِهِ، وَأَجَلِهِ، وَعَمَلِهِ، وَشَقِيٌّ أَمْ سَعِيدٍ؛ فَوَاللَّهِ الَّذِي لَا إِلَهَ غَيْرُهُ إِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ لَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَهَا إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الْكِتَابُ فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ فَيَدْخُلُهَا. وَإِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ لَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَهَا إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الْكِتَابُ فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ فَيَدْخُلُهَا

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ, the truthful and the believed, told us: "The creation of each of you is gathered in his mother's womb for forty days as a drop, then he becomes a clinging clot for the same period, then a lump of flesh for the same period. Then the angel is sent to him and blows the soul into him, and he is commanded with four words: to write his provision, his lifespan, his deeds, and whether he will be wretched or happy. By Allah, besides whom there is no god, one of you may do the deeds of

the people of Paradise until there is only an arm's length between him and it, then what was written overtakes him, and he does the deeds of the people of the Fire and enters it. And one of you may do the deeds of the people of the Fire until there is only an arm's length between him and it, then what was written overtakes him, and he does the deeds of the people of Paradise and enters it."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd. Al-Bukhārī (3208) and Muslim (2643).

- Allah has written each person's provision, lifespan, deeds and final end; nothing happens outside His knowledge and decree.
- Deeds are judged by how a person ends, so a believer should never feel safe from going astray, nor despair of anyone's guidance.
- The decree does not remove effort: we act, and ask Allah for a good ending.

Ḥadīth 5 · Rejecting innovation in the religion

عَنْ أُمِّ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أُمِّ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ عَائِشَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا، قَالَتْ: قَالَ: رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ مَنْ أَحْدَثَ فِي أَمْرِنَا هَذَا مَا لَيْسَ مِنْهُ فَهُوَ رَدٌّ

وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ لِمُسْلِمٍ: مَنْ عَمِلَ عَمَلًا لَيْسَ عَلَيْهِ أَمْرُنَا فَهُوَ رَدٌّ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Whoever introduces into this matter of ours something that is not from it, it is rejected." In a narration of Muslim: "Whoever does a deed that is not in accordance with our matter, it is rejected."

Narrated by ʿĀʾishah, Mother of the Believers. Al-Bukhārī (2697) and Muslim (1718).

- A deed is accepted only when it is sincere (ḥadīth 1) and in line with the Sunnah (this ḥadīth).
- "This matter of ours" means the religion: acts of worship must have a basis in the Qur'an and Sunnah.
- Good intentions do not make an invented act of worship acceptable.

Ḥadīth 6 · The lawful, the unlawful and the doubtful

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ اللَّهِ النُّعْمَانِ بْنِ بَشِيرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا، قَالَ: سَمِعْت رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: إنَّ الْحَلَالَ بَيِّنٌ، وَإِنَّ الْحَرَامَ بَيِّنٌ، وَبَيْنَهُمَا أُمُورٌ مُشْتَبِهَاتٌ لَا يَعْلَمُهُنَّ كَثِيرٌ مِنْ النَّاسِ، فَمَنْ اتَّقَى الشُّبُهَاتِ فَقَدْ اسْتَبْرَأَ لِدِينِهِ وَعِرْضِهِ، وَمَنْ وَقَعَ فِي الشُّبُهَاتِ وَقَعَ فِي الْحَرَامِ، كَالرَّاعِي يَرْعَى حَوْلَ الْحِمَى يُوشِكُ أَنْ يَرْتَعَ فِيهِ، أَلَا وَإِنَّ لِكُلِّ مَلِكٍ حِمًى، أَلَا وَإِنَّ حِمَى

اللَّهِ مَحَارِمُهُ، أَلَا وَإِنَّ فِي الْجَسَدِ مُضْغَةً إِذَا صَلَحَتْ صَلَحَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، وَإِذَا فَسَدَتْ فَسَدَ الْجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، أَلَا وَهِيَ الْقَلْبُ

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: "The lawful is clear and the unlawful is clear, and between them are doubtful matters which many people do not know. Whoever guards against the doubtful matters has protected his religion and his honour, and whoever falls into the doubtful matters falls into the unlawful, like a shepherd grazing around a sanctuary who is about to graze in it. Indeed every king has a sanctuary, and Allah's sanctuary is what He has forbidden. Indeed in the body there is a lump of flesh: if it is sound, the whole body is sound, and if it is corrupt, the whole body is corrupt. Indeed, it is the heart."

Narrated by an-Nuʿmān ibn Bashīr. Al-Bukhārī (52) and Muslim (1599).

- Most rulings are clear; a smaller area is unclear to many people, and caution there protects your religion and reputation.
- Those with knowledge can clarify doubtful matters, so ask the people of knowledge.
- Small compromises lead to bigger ones, like a shepherd who grazes too close to a private pasture.

Ḥadīth 7 · The religion is sincere advice

عَنْ أَبِي رُقَيَّةَ تَمِيمِ بْنِ أَوْسٍ الدَّارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ قَالَ: الدِّينُ النَّصِيحَةُ. قُلْنَا: لِمَنْ؟ قَالَ: لِلَّهِ، وَلِكِتَابِهِ، وَلِرَسُولِهِ، وَلِأَئِمَّةِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَعَامَّتِهِمْ.

The Prophet ﷺ said: "The religion is naṣīḥah (sincere advice and goodwill)." We said: "To whom?" He said: "To Allah, to His Book, to His Messenger, to the leaders of the Muslims and to their common people."

Narrated by Tamīm ad-Dārī. Muslim (55).

- Naṣīḥah means sincerely wanting good for someone and acting on it; the Prophet ﷺ described the whole religion with it.
- Naṣīḥah to Allah is worshipping Him sincerely; to His Book is reciting, understanding and acting on it; to His Messenger ﷺ is loving and following him.
- Advice to leaders is given respectfully and in the right way, and supporting them in good.

Ḥadīth 8 · The sanctity of a Muslim

عَنْ ابْنِ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: أُمِرْتُ أَنْ أُقَاتِلَ النَّاسَ حَتَّى يَشْهَدُوا أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَيُقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ، وَيُؤْتُوا الزَّكَاةَ؛ فَإِذَا فَعَلُوا ذَلِكَ عَصَمُوا مِنِّي دِمَاءَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ إِلَّا بِحَقِّ الْإِسْلَامِ، وَحِسَابُهُمْ عَلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "I have been commanded to fight the people until they testify that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah, establish the prayer and pay the zakāh. If they do that, they have protected their blood and their wealth from me, except by the right of Islām, and their reckoning is with Allah the Exalted."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar. Al-Bukhārī (25) and Muslim (22).

- Whoever outwardly accepts Islām and its practices has his life and property protected; we judge by what is apparent.
- What is in people's hearts is for Allah to judge, not for us to guess.
- Prayer and zakāh are so central that they are named alongside the shahādah.

Ḥadīth 9 · Do what you can, avoid what is forbidden

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ بْنِ صَخْرٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْت رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: مَا نَهَيْتُكُمْ عَنْهُ فَاجْتَنِبُوهُ، وَمَا أَمَرْتُكُمْ بِهِ فَأْتُوا مِنْهُ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ، فَإِنَّمَا أَهْلَكَ الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ كَثْرَةُ مَسَائِلِهِمْ وَاخْتِلَافُهُمْ عَلَى أَنْبِيَائِهِمْ

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: "What I have forbidden you, avoid it; and what I have commanded you, do as much of it as you are able. What destroyed those before you was only their excessive questioning and their disagreeing with their prophets."

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Al-Bukhārī (7288) and Muslim (1337).

- Prohibitions are to be left completely, since leaving something is within everyone's ability.
- Commands are done according to ability: Allah does not burden a soul beyond its capacity.
- Asking to learn is good; asking to argue, to find loopholes or to make things harder is blameworthy.

Ḥadīth 10 · Allah is pure and accepts only what is pure

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ إِنَّ اللَّهَ طَيِّبٌ لَا يَقْبَلُ إِلَّا طَيِّبًا، وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ أَمَرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ بِمَا أَمَرَ بِهِ الْمُرْسَلِينَ فَقَالَ تَعَالَى: يَا أَيُّهَا الرُّسُلُ كُلُوا مِنْ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَاعْمَلُوا صَالِحًا، وَقَالَ تَعَالَى: يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُلُوا مِنْ طَيِّبَاتِ مَا رَزَقْنَاكُمْ ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ الرَّجُلَ يُطِيلُ السَّفَرَ أَشْعَثَ أَغْبَرَ يَمُدُّ يَدَيْهِ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ: يَا رَبِّ! يَا رَبِّ! وَمَطْعَمُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَمَشْرَبُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَمَلْبَسُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَغُذِّيَ بِالْحَرَامِ، فَأَنَّى يُسْتَجَابُ لَهُ؟

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Allah is pure (ṭayyib) and accepts only what is pure. Allah has commanded the believers with what He commanded the messengers. He said: 'O messengers, eat from the good things and do righteous deeds' (al-Muʾminūn 23:51), and He said: 'O you who believe, eat from the good things We have provided you' (al-Baqarah 2:172)." Then he mentioned a man who travels far, dishevelled and dusty, stretching his hands to the sky: "O Lord! O Lord!" while his food is unlawful, his drink is unlawful, his clothing is unlawful and he has been nourished with the unlawful. "So how can he be answered?"

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Muslim (1015).

- Allah accepts deeds, charity and earnings that are good and lawful.
- Lawful food and income are a condition for duʿāʾ being answered.
- Even a traveller in hardship, raising his hands, can be blocked from an answer by unlawful earnings.

Ḥadīth 11 · Leave what makes you doubt

عَنْ أَبِي مُحَمَّدٍ الْحَسَنِ بْنِ عَلِيِّ بْنِ أَبِي طَالِبٍ سِبْطِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ وَرَيْحَانَتِهِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا، قَالَ: حَفِظْتُ مِنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ دَعْ مَا يُرِيبُكَ إِلَى مَا لَا يُرِيبُكَ.
وَقَالَ التِّرْمِذِيُّ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ

I memorised from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ: "Leave what makes you doubt for what does not make you doubt."

Narrated by al-Ḥasan ibn ʿAlī, grandson of the Prophet ﷺ. At-Tirmidhī (2518), who said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ; and an-Nasāʾī (5711).

- When you are unsure whether something is right, choose the option you are sure about.
- Doubt unsettles the heart; certainty brings calm and peace.
- This applies to food, earnings, speech and acts of worship.

Ḥadīth 12 · Leaving what does not concern you

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ مِنْ حُسْنِ إِسْلَامِ الْمَرْءِ تَرْكُهُ مَا لَا يَعْنِيهِ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Part of the excellence of a person's Islām is his leaving what does not concern him."

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. At-Tirmidhī (2317), who said it is ḥasan; and Ibn Mājah (3976).

- A good Muslim spends his time and words on what benefits his religion and his life.
- Gossip, prying into others' affairs and idle talk weaken a person's Islām.
- Social media makes this ḥadīth especially important: not every post deserves your attention.

Ḥadīth 13 · Love for your brother what you love for yourself

عَنْ أَبِي حَمْزَةَ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ خَادِمِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ عَنْ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لِأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ

The Prophet ﷺ said: "None of you truly believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself."

Narrated by Anas ibn Mālik, servant of the Prophet ﷺ. Al-Bukhārī (13) and Muslim (45).

- Complete faith includes wanting good for others as you want it for yourself.
- This removes envy: you are happy when your brother receives good.
- It shows in action: sharing knowledge, giving advice and treating people fairly.

Ḥadīth 14 · The sanctity of a Muslim's life

عَنْ ابْنِ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ لَا يَحِلُّ دَمُ امْرِئٍ مُسْلِمٍ إِلَّا بِإِحْدَى ثَلَاثٍ: الثَّيِّبُ الزَّانِي، وَالنَّفْسُ بِالنَّفْسِ، وَالتَّارِكُ لِدِينِهِ الْمُفَارِقُ لِلْجَمَاعَةِ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "The blood of a Muslim is not lawful except in one of three cases: the married person who commits adultery, a life for a life, and one who abandons his religion and separates from the community."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd. Al-Bukhārī (6878) and Muslim (1676).

- The life of a Muslim is sacred; the default is complete protection.
- The three exceptions are legal punishments, carried out only by a lawful authority after due process, never by individuals.
- This ḥadīth shows how seriously Islām guards life, family and the community.

Ḥadīth 15 · Speak good, honour your neighbour and guest

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: مَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاَللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيَقُلْ خَيْرًا أَوْ لِيَصْمُتْ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاَللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ جَارَهُ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاَللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ ضَيْفَهُ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him speak good or stay silent. Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him honour his neighbour. Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him honour his guest."

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Al-Bukhārī (6018) and Muslim (47).

- Before speaking, ask: is it good? If not, silence is better.
- Honouring neighbours includes kindness, help and not harming them with noise or rubbish.
- Honouring guests is a sign of faith: welcome them, feed them and serve them.

Ḥadīth 16 · Do not become angry

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَجُلًا قَالَ لِلنَّبِيِّ ﷺ أَوْصِنِي. قَالَ: لَا تَغْضَبْ، فَرَدَّدَ مِرَارًا، قَالَ: لَا تَغْضَبْ

A man said to the Prophet ﷺ: “Advise me.” He said: “Do not become angry.” The man repeated his request several times, and each time he said: “Do not become angry.”

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Al-Bukhārī (6116).

- Uncontrolled anger leads to many sins: harsh words, cutting ties, injustice and regret.
- Control anger by seeking refuge in Allah, staying silent, changing your position and making wuḍūʾ.
- Anger for Allah’s sake when His limits are violated is different from personal anger.

Ḥadīth 17 · Excellence in everything

عَنْ أَبِي يَعْلَى شَدَّادِ بْنِ أَوْسٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الْإِحْسَانَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، فَإِذَا قَتَلْتُمْ فَأَحْسِنُوا الْقِتْلَةَ، وَإِذَا ذَبَحْتُمْ فَأَحْسِنُوا الذِّبْحَةَ، وَلْيُحِدَّ أَحَدُكُمْ شَفْرَتَهُ، وَلْيُرِحْ ذَبِيحَتَهُ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Allah has prescribed excellence (iḥsān) in everything. So when you kill, kill well; and when you slaughter, slaughter well. Let one of you sharpen his blade and spare his animal suffering.”

Narrated by Shaddād ibn Aws. Muslim (1955).

- Iḥsān is required in all things, from worship to work and even the treatment of animals.
- Islām forbids needless cruelty, even when an act is permitted.
- Practical care, such as sharpening the knife and not slaughtering in front of other animals, is part of the religion.

Ḥadīth 18 · Taqwā wherever you are

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ جُنْدَبِ بْنِ جُنَادَةَ، وَأَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ مُعَاذِ بْنِ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا، عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: اتَّقِ اللَّهَ حَيْثُمَا كُنْت، وَأَتْبِعْ السَّيِّئَةَ الْحَسَنَةَ تَمْحُهَا، وَخَالِقْ النَّاسَ بِخُلُقٍ حَسَنٍ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Fear Allah wherever you are, follow a bad deed with a good deed and it will wipe it out, and treat people with good character."

Narrated by Abū Dharr and Muʿādh ibn Jabal. At-Tirmidhī (1987), who said: ḥasan.

- Taqwā is not only in the mosque: it is in private and public, at home, at school and online.
- When you slip, follow it quickly with a good deed and repentance.
- Good character with people is a core part of religion, not an extra.

Ḥadīth 19 · Be mindful of Allah, He will protect you

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: كُنْت خَلْفَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَوْمًا، فَقَالَ: يَا غُلَامُ! إنِّي أُعَلِّمُك كَلِمَاتٍ: احْفَظْ اللَّهَ يَحْفَظْك، احْفَظْ اللَّهَ تَجِدْهُ تُجَاهَك، إذَا سَأَلْت فَاسْأَلْ اللَّهَ، وَإِذَا اسْتَعَنْت فَاسْتَعِنْ بِاَللَّهِ، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ الْأُمَّةَ لَوْ اجْتَمَعَتْ عَلَى أَنْ يَنْفَعُوك بِشَيْءٍ لَمْ يَنْفَعُوك إلَّا بِشَيْءٍ قَدْ كَتَبَهُ اللَّهُ لَك، وَإِنْ اجْتَمَعُوا عَلَى أَنْ يَضُرُّوك بِشَيْءٍ لَمْ يَضُرُّوك إلَّا بِشَيْءٍ قَدْ كَتَبَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْك؛ رُفِعَتْ الْأَقْلَامُ، وَجَفَّتْ الصُّحُفُ.

وَفِي رِوَايَةِ غَيْرِ التِّرْمِذِيِّ: احْفَظْ اللَّهَ تَجِدْهُ أَمَامَك، تَعَرَّفْ إلَى اللَّهِ فِي الرَّخَاءِ يَعْرِفُك فِي الشِّدَّةِ، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ مَا أَخْطَأَك لَمْ يَكُنْ لِيُصِيبَك، وَمَا أَصَابَك لَمْ يَكُنْ لِيُخْطِئَك، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ النَّصْرَ مَعَ الصَّبْرِ، وَأَنْ الْفَرَجَ مَعَ الْكَرْبِ، وَأَنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا

I was behind the Messenger of Allah ﷺ one day and he said: "Young man, I will teach you some words. Be mindful of Allah and He will protect you. Be mindful of Allah and you will find Him before you. When you ask, ask Allah; and when you seek help, seek help from Allah. Know that if the whole nation gathered together to benefit you with something, they would not benefit you except with what Allah had already written for you; and if they gathered together to harm you with something, they would not harm you except with what Allah had already written against you. The pens have been lifted and the pages have dried." In another narration: "Be mindful of Allah and you will find Him in front of you. Get

to know Allah in times of ease and He will know you in times of hardship. Know that what missed you was never going to reach you, and what reached you was never going to miss you. Know that victory comes with patience, relief comes with hardship, and with difficulty comes ease."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās. At-Tirmidhī (2516), who said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ; the second narration is in Aḥmad.

- "Be mindful of Allah" means guarding His commands and limits; in return He guards you.
- Ask Allah alone and rely on Him; people cannot benefit or harm you except by His decree.
- Remember Allah in easy times, and He will be with you in hard times.

Ḥadīth 20 · Modesty (ḥayāʾ)

عَنْ أَبِي مَسْعُودٍ عُقْبَةَ بْنِ عَمْرٍو الْأَنْصَارِيِّ الْبَدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ إِنَّ مِمَّا أَدْرَكَ النَّاسُ مِنْ كَلَامِ النُّبُوَّةِ الْأُولَى: إِذَا لَمْ تَسْتَحِ فَاصْنَعْ مَا شِئْتَ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Among the words people have received from the earliest prophecy is: if you feel no shame, then do as you wish."

Narrated by Abū Masʿūd ʿUqbah ibn ʿAmr al-Anṣārī. Al-Bukhārī (3483).

- Ḥayāʾ (modesty and a sense of shame) stops a person from doing what is wrong.
- This saying has been known since the earliest prophets: it is a shared message of revelation.
- It can be understood as a warning (a shameless person will do anything) or as a rule (if an act is not shameful, you may do it).

Ḥadīth 21 · Say: I believe in Allah, then be steadfast

عَنْ أَبِي عَمْرٍو وَقِيلَ: أَبِي عَمْرَةَ سُفْيَانَ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قُلْتُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ! قُلْ لِي فِي الْإِسْلَامِ قَوْلًا لَا أَسْأَلُ عَنْهُ أَحَدًا غَيْرَكَ؛ قَالَ: قُلْ: آمَنْتُ بِاللَّهِ ثُمَّ اسْتَقِمْ

I said: "O Messenger of Allah, tell me something about Islām that I will not need to ask anyone else about." He said: "Say: I believe in Allah, then be steadfast."

Narrated by Sufyān ibn ʿAbdillāh ath-Thaqafī. Muslim (38).

- The whole religion is summed up in two things: true faith and staying firm on it.
- Istiqāmah (steadfastness) means staying on the straight path in belief, worship and conduct.
- Consistency matters more than bursts of effort.

Ḥadīth 22 · The obligations that lead to Paradise

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ اللَّهِ جَابِرِ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ الْأَنْصَارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا: أَنَّ رَجُلًا سَأَلَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ: أَرَأَيْت إِذَا صَلَّيْت الْمَكْتُوبَاتِ، وَصُمْت رَمَضَانَ، وَأَحْلَلْت الْحَلَالَ، وَحَرَّمْت الْحَرَامَ، وَلَمْ أَزِدْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ شَيْئًا؛ أَأَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ؟ قَالَ: نَعَمْ

A man asked the Messenger of Allah ﷺ: "Tell me: if I pray the obligatory prayers, fast Ramaḍān, treat the lawful as lawful and the unlawful as unlawful, and do nothing more than that, will I enter Paradise?" He said: "Yes."

Narrated by Jābir ibn ʿAbdillāh al-Anṣārī. Muslim (15).

- Doing the obligations and avoiding the prohibitions is the path to Paradise.
- "Treating the lawful as lawful" means believing it lawful; "treating the unlawful as unlawful" means believing it unlawful and avoiding it.
- Islām is achievable: the basic path is clear and within reach.

Ḥadīth 23 · Purity is half of faith

عَنْ أَبِي مَالِكٍ الْحَارِثِ بْنِ عَاصِمٍ الْأَشْعَرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ الطَّهُورُ شَطْرُ الْإِيمَانِ، وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ تَمْلَأُ الْمِيزَانَ، وَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ تَمْلَآنِ -أَوْ: تَمْلَأُ- مَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ، وَالصَّلَاةُ نُورٌ، وَالصَّدَقَةُ بُرْهَانٌ، وَالصَّبْرُ ضِيَاءٌ، وَالْقُرْآنُ حُجَّةٌ لَك أَوْ عَلَيْك، كُلُّ النَّاسِ يَغْدُو، فَبَائِعٌ نَفْسَهُ فَمُعْتِقُهَا أَوْ مُوبِقُهَا

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Purity is half of faith. Al-ḥamdu lillāh (praise be to Allah) fills the scale, and subḥān Allāh wal-ḥamdu lillāh fill (or: fills) what is between the heavens and the earth. Prayer is light, charity is proof, patience is radiance, and the Qur'an is an argument for you or against you. Everyone goes out in the morning and sells himself, either freeing himself or destroying himself."

Narrated by Abū Mālik al-Ashʿarī. Muslim (223).

- Purity, of body and of heart, is a great part of faith.
- Small words of dhikr carry enormous weight on the scale.
- Prayer gives light, charity proves faith, and patience gives steady light through hardship.

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ الْغِفَارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فِيمَا يَرْوِيهِ عَنْ رَبِّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى، أَنَّهُ قَالَ: يَا عِبَادِي: إِنِّي حَرَّمْت الظُّلْمَ عَلَى نَفْسِي، وَجَعَلْته بَيْنَكُمْ مُحَرَّمًا؛ فَلَا تَظَالَمُوا. يَا عِبَادِي! كُلُّكُمْ ضَالٌّ إِلَّا مَنْ هَدَيْته، فَاسْتَهْدُونِي أَهْدِكُمْ. يَا عِبَادِي! كُلُّكُمْ جَائِعٌ إِلَّا مَنْ أَطْعَمْته، فَاسْتَطْعِمُونِي أُطْعِمْكُمْ. يَا عِبَادِي! كُلُّكُمْ عَارٍ إِلَّا مَنْ كَسَوْته، فَاسْتَكْسُونِي أَكْسُكُمْ. يَا عِبَادِي! إِنَّكُمْ تُخْطِئُونَ بِاللَّيْلِ وَالنَّهَارِ، وَأَنَا أَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا؛ فَاسْتَغْفِرُونِي أَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ. يَا عِبَادِي! إِنَّكُمْ لَنْ تَبْلُغُوا ضُرِّي فَتَضُرُّونِي، وَلَنْ تَبْلُغُوا نَفْعِي فَتَنْفَعُونِي. يَا عِبَادِي! لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ كَانُوا عَلَى أَتْقَى قَلْبِ رَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْكُمْ، مَا زَادَ ذَلِكَ فِي مُلْكِي شَيْئًا. يَا عِبَادِي! لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ كَانُوا عَلَى أَفْجَرِ قَلْبِ رَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْكُمْ، مَا نَقَصَ ذَلِكَ مِنْ مُلْكِي شَيْئًا. يَا عِبَادِي! لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ قَامُوا فِي صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ، فَسَأَلُونِي، فَأَعْطَيْت كُلَّ وَاحِدٍ مَسْأَلَته، مَا نَقَصَ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا عِنْدِي إِلَّا كَمَا يَنْقُصُ الْمِخْيَطُ إِذَا أُدْخِلَ الْبَحْرَ. يَا عِبَادِي! إِنَّمَا هِيَ أَعْمَالُكُمْ أُحْصِيهَا لَكُمْ، ثُمَّ أُوَفِّيكُمْ إِيَّاهَا؛ فَمَنْ وَجَدَ خَيْرًا فَلْيَحْمَدْ اللَّهَ، وَمَنْ وَجَدَ غَيْرَ ذَلِكَ فَلَا يَلُومَن إِلَّا نَفْسَهُ

The Prophet ﷺ narrated from his Lord: “O My servants, I have forbidden injustice for Myself and made it forbidden among you, so do not wrong one another. O My servants, all of you are astray except those I guide, so seek guidance from Me and I will guide you. O My servants, all of you are hungry except those I feed, so seek food from Me and I will feed you. O My servants, all of you are naked except those I clothe, so seek clothing from Me and I will clothe you. O My servants, you sin by night and by day, and I forgive all sins, so seek forgiveness from Me and I will forgive you. O My servants, you cannot reach harming Me so as to harm Me, and you cannot reach benefiting Me so as to benefit Me. O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, your humans and your jinn, were as pious as the most pious heart of any one of you, that would not add anything to My dominion. O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, your humans and your jinn, were as wicked as the most wicked heart of any one of you, that would not decrease anything from My dominion. O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, your humans and your jinn, stood on one plain and asked of Me, and I gave each one what he asked, that would not decrease what I have except as a needle decreases the sea when it is dipped into it. O My servants, it is only your deeds that I record for you and then repay you for. So whoever finds good, let him praise Allah, and whoever finds other than that, let him blame no one but himself.”

Narrated by Abū Dharr al-Ghifārī. Muslim (2577).

- This is a ḥadīth qudsī: the Prophet ﷺ relates words from Allah.
- Allah forbade injustice for Himself; we must never wrong anyone.
- Every blessing, guidance, food, clothing and forgiveness, is from Allah, so ask Him for everything.

Ḥadīth 25 • Every good deed is charity

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَيْضًا، أَنَّ نَاسًا مِنْ أَصْحَابِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالُوا لِلنَّبِيِّ ﷺ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ذَهَبَ أَهْلُ الدُّثُورِ بِالْأُجُورِ؛ يُصَلُّونَ كَمَا نُصَلِّي، وَيَصُومُونَ كَمَا نَصُومُ، وَيَتَصَدَّقُونَ بِفُضُولِ أَمْوَالِهِمْ. قَالَ: أَوَلَيْسَ قَدْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ مَا تَصَّدَّقُونَ؟ إِنَّ بِكُلِّ تَسْبِيحَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَكْبِيرَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَحْمِيدَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَهْلِيلَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَأَمْرٌ بِمَعْرُوفٍ صَدَقَةٌ، وَنَهْيٌ عَنْ مُنْكَرٍ صَدَقَةٌ، وَفِي بُضْعِ أَحَدِكُمْ صَدَقَةٌ. قَالُوا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ أَيَأْتِي أَحَدُنَا شَهْوَتَهُ وَيَكُونُ لَهُ فِيهَا أَجْرٌ؟ قَالَ: أَرَأَيْتُمْ لَوْ وَضَعَهَا فِي حَرَامٍ أَكَانَ عَلَيْهِ وِزْرٌ؟ فَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا وَضَعَهَا فِي الْحَلَالِ، كَانَ لَهُ أَجْرٌ

Some of the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to him: “O Messenger of Allah, the wealthy have taken all the reward. They pray as we pray, fast as we fast, and give charity from their extra wealth.” He said: “Has Allah not given you things to give in charity? Every tasbīḥ is charity, every takbīr is charity, every taḥmīd is charity, every tahlīl is charity, enjoining good is charity, forbidding evil is charity, and in the intimacy of one of you with his wife there is charity.” They said: “O Messenger of Allah, does one of us fulfil his desire and get a reward for it?” He said: “Do you not see that if he did it in the unlawful, he would bear a sin? So likewise, if he does it in the lawful, he has a reward.”

Narrated by Abū Dharr al-Ghifārī. Muslim (1006).

- The poor Companions competed in good deeds, not in wealth.
- Dhikr and enjoining good are charity open to everyone, rich or poor.
- Lawful acts done with a good intention, even meeting one’s desires in marriage, are rewarded.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ كُلُّ سُلَامَى مِنْ النَّاسِ عَلَيْهِ صَدَقَةٌ، كُلَّ يَوْمٍ تَطْلُعُ فِيهِ الشَّمْسُ تَعْدِلُ بَيْنَ اثْنَيْنِ صَدَقَةٌ، وَتُعِينُ الرَّجُلَ فِي دَابَّتِهِ فَتَحْمِلُهُ عَلَيْهَا أَوْ تَرْفَعُ لَهُ عَلَيْهَا مَتَاعَهُ صَدَقَةٌ، وَالْكَلِمَةُ الطَّيِّبَةُ صَدَقَةٌ، وَبِكُلِّ خُطْوَةٍ تَمْشِيهَا إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ صَدَقَةٌ، وَتُمِيطُ الْأَذَى عَنْ الطَّرِيقِ صَدَقَةٌ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Charity is due on every joint of a person, every day the sun rises. Judging justly between two people is charity. Helping a man with his mount, lifting him onto it or lifting his belongings onto it, is charity. A good word is charity. Every step you take to the prayer is charity. Removing something harmful from the road is charity.”

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Al-Bukhārī (2989) and Muslim (1009).

- Each of our joints is a blessing, and thanks for them is due every day.
- Charity is not only money: justice, help, kind words and walking to prayer are all charity.
- Small, everyday acts of service carry great reward.

Ḥadīth 27 · Righteousness and sin

عَنْ النَّوَّاسِ بْنِ سَمْعَانَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: الْبِرُّ حُسْنُ الْخُلُقِ، وَالْإِثْمُ مَا حَاكَ فِي صَدْرِك، وَكَرِهْت أَنْ يَطَّلِعَ عَلَيْهِ النَّاسُ

وَعَنْ وَابِصَةَ بْنِ مَعْبَدٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: أَتَيْت رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ: جِئْتَ تَسْأَلُ عَنْ الْبِرِّ؟ قُلْت: نَعَمْ. فَقَالَ: اسْتَفْتِ قَلْبَك، الْبِرُّ مَا اطْمَأَنَّتْ إلَيْهِ النَّفْسُ، وَاطْمَأَنَّ إلَيْهِ الْقَلْبُ، وَالْإِثْمُ مَا حَاكَ فِي النَّفْسِ وَتَرَدَّدَ فِي الصَّدْرِ، وَإِنْ أَفْتَاك النَّاسُ وَأَفْتَوْك

The Prophet ﷺ said: “Righteousness is good character, and sin is what wavers in your heart and you dislike people finding out about it.” And Wābiṣah said: I came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and he said: “You have come to ask about righteousness?” I said: “Yes.” He said: “Consult your heart. Righteousness is what the soul feels at ease with and the heart feels at ease with, and sin is what wavers in the soul and moves back and forth in the chest, even if people give you rulings and give you rulings again.”

Narrated by an-Nawwās ibn Samʿān and Wābiṣah ibn Maʿbad. Muslim (2553); the second narration is in Aḥmad and ad-Dārimī, graded ḥasan by an-Nawawī.

- Good character is at the heart of righteousness (birr).
- A sound heart feels uneasy about sin and wants to hide it.
- This applies to a believer whose heart is alive with faith, and to unclear matters; clear rulings of the Sharīʿah come first.

Ḥadīth 28 · Hold fast to the Sunnah

عَنْ أَبِي نَجِيحٍ الْعِرْبَاضِ بْنِ سَارِيَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: وَعَظَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ مَوْعِظَةً وَجِلَتْ مِنْهَا الْقُلُوبُ، وَذَرَفَتْ مِنْهَا الْعُيُونُ، فَقُلْنَا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ! كَأَنَّهَا مَوْعِظَةُ مُوَدِّعٍ فَأَوْصِنَا، قَالَ: أُوصِيكُمْ بِتَقْوَى اللَّهِ، وَالسَّمْعِ وَالطَّاعَةِ وَإِنْ تَأَمَّرَ عَلَيْكُمْ عَبْدٌ، فَإِنَّهُ مَنْ يَعِشْ مِنْكُمْ فَسَيَرَى اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا، فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي وَسُنَّةِ الْخُلَفَاءِ الرَّاشِدِينَ الْمَهْدِيِّينَ، عَضُّوا عَلَيْهَا بِالنَّوَاجِذِ، وَإِيَّاكُمْ وَمُحْدَثَاتِ الْأُمُورِ؛ فَإِنَّ كُلَّ

بِدْعَةٍ ضَلَالَةٌ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ gave us a sermon that made our hearts fearful and our eyes weep. We said: "O Messenger of Allah, it is as if this is a farewell sermon, so advise us." He said: "I advise you to fear Allah, and to listen and obey even if a slave is placed in authority over you. Whoever among you lives will see much disagreement, so hold to my Sunnah and the Sunnah of the rightly guided caliphs. Bite onto it with your molar teeth. And beware of newly invented matters, for every innovation is misguidance."

Narrated by al-ʿIrbāḍ ibn Sāriyah. Abū Dāwūd (4607) and at-Tirmidhī (2676), who said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ.

- The Prophet's ﷺ final advice centres on taqwā, unity and following the Sunnah.
- Disagreement will come; the way out is holding firmly to the Sunnah and the way of the rightly guided caliphs.
- "Bite onto it with your molars" means hold on as tightly as possible.

Ḥadīth 29 · The deeds that lead to Paradise, and the tongue

عَنْ مُعَاذِ بْنِ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قُلْت يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ! أَخْبِرْنِي بِعَمَلٍ يُدْخِلُنِي الْجَنَّةَ وَيُبَاعِدُنِي مِنْ النَّارِ، قَالَ: لَقَدْ سَأَلْت عَنْ عَظِيمٍ، وَإِنَّهُ لَيَسِيرٌ عَلَى مَنْ يَسَّرَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ: تَعْبُدُ اللَّهَ لَا تُشْرِكْ بِهِ شَيْئًا، وَتُقِيمُ الصَّلَاةَ، وَتُؤْتِي الزَّكَاةَ، وَتَصُومُ رَمَضَانَ، وَتَحُجُّ الْبَيْتَ، ثُمَّ قَالَ: أَلَا أَدُلُّك عَلَى أَبْوَابِ الْخَيْرِ؟ الصَّوْمُ جُنَّةٌ، وَالصَّدَقَةُ تُطْفِئُ الْخَطِيئَةَ كَمَا يُطْفِئُ الْمَاءُ النَّارَ، وَصَلَاةُ الرَّجُلِ فِي جَوْفِ اللَّيْلِ، ثُمَّ تَلَا: تَتَجَافَى جُنُوبُهُمْ عَنِ الْمَضَاجِعِ حَتَّى بَلَغَ يَعْمَلُونَ، ثُمَّ قَالَ: أَلَا أُخْبِرُك بِرَأْسِ الْأَمْرِ وَعَمُودِهِ وَذُرْوَةِ سَنَامِهِ؟ قُلْت: بَلَى يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ. قَالَ: رَأْسُ الْأَمْرِ الْإِسْلَامُ، وَعَمُودُهُ الصَّلَاةُ، وَذُرْوَةُ سَنَامِهِ الْجِهَادُ، ثُمَّ قَالَ: أَلَا أُخْبِرُك بِمَلَاكِ ذَلِكَ كُلِّهِ؟ فَقُلْت: بَلَى يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ! فَأَخَذَ بِلِسَانِهِ وَقَالَ: كُفَّ عَلَيْك هَذَا. قُلْت: يَا نَبِيَّ اللَّهِ وَإِنَّا لَمُؤَاخَذُونَ بِمَا نَتَكَلَّمُ بِهِ؟ فَقَالَ: ثَكِلَتْك أُمُّك وَهَلْ يَكُبُّ النَّاسَ عَلَى وُجُوهِهِمْ -أَوْ قَالَ عَلَى مَنَاخِرِهِمْ- إلَّا حَصَائِدُ أَلْسِنَتِهِمْ؟!

I said: "O Messenger of Allah, tell me of a deed that will admit me to Paradise and keep me far from the Fire." He said: "You have asked about something great, yet it is easy for whoever Allah makes it easy for. Worship Allah without associating anything with Him, establish the prayer, pay the zakāh, fast Ramaḍān and perform Ḥajj to the House." Then he said: "Shall I not guide you to the gates of goodness? Fasting is a shield; charity extinguishes sin as water extinguishes fire; and a man's prayer in the depth of the night." Then he recited: "Their sides forsake their beds…" until he reached "…what they used to do" (as-Sajdah 32:16–17). Then he said: "Shall I not tell you of the head of the matter, its pillar and its peak?" I

said: “Yes, O Messenger of Allah.” He said: “The head of the matter is Islām, its pillar is the prayer, and its peak is jihād.” Then he said: “Shall I not tell you of what controls all of that?” I said: “Yes, O Messenger of Allah.” He took hold of his tongue and said: “Restrain this.” I said: “O Prophet of Allah, will we be held to account for what we say?” He said: “May your mother lose you, Muʿādh! Is there anything that throws people on their faces (or he said: on their noses) into the Fire other than the harvest of their tongues?”

Narrated by Muʿādh ibn Jabal. At-Tirmidhī (2616), who said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ.

- Paradise is great, but the path is easy for those Allah helps: the pillars of Islām first.
- The gates of goodness are fasting, charity and night prayer.
- Prayer is the pillar of the religion.

Ḥadīth 30 · The limits set by Allah

عَنْ أَبِي ثَعْلَبَةَ الْخُشَنِيِّ جُرْثُومِ بن نَاشِر رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَال: إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى فَرَضَ فَرَائِضَ فَلَا تُضَيِّعُوهَا، وَحَدَّ حُدُودًا فَلَا تَعْتَدُوهَا، وَحَرَّمَ أَشْيَاءَ فَلَا تَنْتَهِكُوهَا، وَسَكَتَ عَنْ أَشْيَاءَ رَحْمَةً لَكُمْ غَيْرَ نِسْيَانٍ فَلَا تَبْحَثُوا عَنْهَا

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Allah the Exalted has laid down obligations, so do not neglect them. He has set limits, so do not overstep them. He has forbidden things, so do not violate them. And He has remained silent about things, out of mercy for you, not out of forgetfulness, so do not go searching into them.”

Narrated by Abū Thaʿlabah al-Khushanī. Ad-Dāraquṭnī in his Sunan and others; graded ḥasan by an-Nawawī.

- Rulings fall into four groups: obligations, limits, prohibitions and things left unaddressed.
- What Allah left unaddressed is a mercy: the default in worldly matters is permissibility.
- Allah does not forget; His silence is deliberate.

Ḥadīth 31 · Be detached from the world

عَنْ أَبِي الْعَبَّاسِ سَهْلِ بْنِ سَعْدٍ السَّاعِدِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: جَاءَ رَجُلٌ إِلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فَقَالَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللهِ! دُلَّنِي عَلَى عَمَلٍ إِذَا عَمِلْتُهُ أَحَبَّنِي اللهُ وَأَحَبَّنِي النَّاسُ؛ فَقَالَ: ازْهَدْ فِي الدُّنْيَا يُحِبَّكَ اللهُ، وَازْهَدْ فِيمَا عِنْدَ النَّاسِ يُحِبَّكَ النَّاسُ

A man came to the Prophet ﷺ and said: "O Messenger of Allah, direct me to a deed which, if I do it, Allah will love me and people will love me." He said: "Be detached from this world and Allah will love you, and be detached from what people have and people will love you."

Narrated by Sahl ibn Saʿd as-Sāʿidī. Ibn Mājah (4102) and others; graded ḥasan by an-Nawawī.

- Zuhd is not giving everything away; it is not letting the world own your heart.
- Allah loves the one whose heart is attached to the Hereafter.
- People love the one who does not look at what is in their hands or envy them.

Ḥadīth 32 · No harm and no reciprocating harm

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ سَعْدِ بْنِ مَالِكِ بْنِ سِنَانٍ الْخُدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: لَا ضَرَرَ وَلَا ضِرَارَ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "There is to be no harm and no reciprocating harm."

Narrated by Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī. Ibn Mājah and ad-Dāraquṭnī; Mālik narrated it in the Muwaṭṭaʾ as mursal; its routes strengthen one another.

- This short ḥadīth is a major principle of Islamic law: harm must be removed.
- You may not harm others, and you may not answer harm with greater harm.
- It applies to neighbours, trade, family, roads and public spaces.

Ḥadīth 33 • The burden of proof

عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: لَوْ يُعْطَى النَّاسُ بِدَعْوَاهُمْ لَادَّعَى رِجَالٌ أَمْوَالَ قَوْمٍ وَدِمَاءَهُمْ، لَكِنَّ الْبَيِّنَةَ عَلَى الْمُدَّعِي، وَالْيَمِينَ عَلَى مَنْ أَنْكَرَ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "If people were given according to their claims, some men would claim the wealth and blood of others. But the proof is upon the claimant, and the oath is upon the one who denies."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās. Al-Bayhaqī with this wording; part of it is in al-Bukhārī and Muslim.

- Claims alone are not enough; justice needs evidence.
- The one who makes a claim must bring proof; the one who denies may take an oath.
- This protects people's wealth, lives and honour from false accusations.

Ḥadīth 34 • Changing what is wrong

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ الْخُدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ سَمِعْت رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: مَنْ رَأَى مِنْكُمْ مُنْكَرًا فَلْيُغَيِّرْهُ بِيَدِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِلِسَانِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِقَلْبِهِ، وَذَلِكَ أَضْعَفُ الْإِيمَانِ

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: "Whoever among you sees something wrong, let him change it with his hand; if he is not able, then with his tongue; and if he is not able, then with his heart, and that is the weakest of faith."

Narrated by Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī. Muslim (49).

- Every Muslim has a duty to respond to wrong according to his ability.
- Changing with the hand is for those with authority over the matter, such as a parent at home or a ruler.
- Changing with the tongue should be done with wisdom and gentle words.

Ḥadīth 35 · The brotherhood of Muslims

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ لَا تَحَاسَدُوا، وَلَا تَنَاجَشُوا، وَلَا تَبَاغَضُوا، وَلَا تَدَابَرُوا، وَلَا يَبِعْ بَعْضُكُمْ عَلَى بَيْعِ بَعْضٍ، وَكُونُوا عِبَادَ اللَّهِ إِخْوَانًا، الْمُسْلِمُ أَخُو الْمُسْلِمِ، لَا يَظْلِمُهُ، وَلَا يَخْذُلُهُ، وَلَا يَكْذِبُهُ، وَلَا يَحْقِرُهُ، التَّقْوَى هَاهُنَا، وَيُشِيرُ إِلَى صَدْرِهِ ثَلَاثَ مَرَّاتٍ، بِحَسْبِ امْرِئٍ مِنْ الشَّرِّ أَنْ يَحْقِرَ أَخَاهُ الْمُسْلِمَ، كُلُّ الْمُسْلِمِ عَلَى الْمُسْلِمِ حَرَامٌ: دَمُهُ وَمَالُهُ وَعِرْضُهُ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Do not envy one another, do not inflate prices against one another, do not hate one another, do not turn your backs on one another, and do not undercut one another’s sales. Be, O servants of Allah, brothers. The Muslim is the brother of the Muslim: he does not wrong him, abandon him, lie to him or look down on him. Taqwā is here,” and he pointed to his chest three times. “It is enough evil for a person to look down on his Muslim brother. All of a Muslim is sacred to another Muslim: his blood, his wealth and his honour.”

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Muslim (2564).

- Envy, hatred and cutting off people destroy brotherhood.
- Fair trade is part of brotherhood: no price-rigging or undercutting.
- Taqwā is in the heart, so do not judge people by appearance.

Ḥadīth 36 · Relieving others and seeking knowledge

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: مَنْ نَفَّسَ عَنْ مُؤْمِنٍ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرَبِ الدُّنْيَا نَفَّسَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرَبِ يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ، وَمَنْ يَسَّرَ عَلَى مُعْسِرٍ، يَسَّرَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ، وَمَنْ سَتَرَ مُسْلِمًا سَتَرَهُ اللَّهُ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ، وَاَللَّهُ فِي عَوْنِ الْعَبْدِ مَا كَانَ الْعَبْدُ فِي عَوْنِ أَخِيهِ، وَمَنْ سَلَكَ طَرِيقًا يَلْتَمِسُ فِيهِ عِلْمًا سَهَّلَ اللَّهُ لَهُ بِهِ طَرِيقًا إِلَى الْجَنَّةِ، وَمَا اجْتَمَعَ قَوْمٌ فِي بَيْتٍ مِنْ بُيُوتِ اللَّهِ يَتْلُونَ كِتَابَ اللَّهِ، وَيَتَدَارَسُونَهُ فِيمَا بَيْنَهُمْ؛ إِلَّا نَزَلَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ السَّكِينَةُ، وَغَشِيَتْهُمْ الرَّحْمَةُ، وَحَفَّتْهُمْ الْمَلَائِكَةُ، وَذَكَرَهُمْ اللَّهُ فِيمَنْ عِنْدَهُ، وَمَنْ بَطَّأَ بِهِ عَمَلُهُ لَمْ يُسْرِعْ بِهِ نَسَبُهُ

The Prophet ﷺ said: “Whoever relieves a believer of a hardship of this world, Allah will relieve him of a

hardship of the Day of Resurrection. Whoever makes things easy for someone in difficulty, Allah will make things easy for him in this world and the Hereafter. Whoever covers a Muslim's faults, Allah will cover his faults in this world and the Hereafter. Allah is in the help of His servant as long as the servant is in the help of his brother. Whoever takes a path seeking knowledge, Allah makes easy for him a path to Paradise. No people gather in one of the houses of Allah, reciting the Book of Allah and studying it among themselves, except that tranquillity descends on them, mercy covers them, the angels surround them and Allah mentions them among those with Him. And whoever is slowed down by his deeds will not be hastened by his lineage."

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Muslim (2699).

- Your reward matches your deed: help others, and Allah helps you.
- Covering others' faults earns Allah's covering of yours.
- Seeking knowledge is a path to Paradise, and study circles of the Qur'an are blessed.

Ḥadīth 37 · How good and bad deeds are recorded

عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ فِيمَا يَرْوِيهِ عَنْ رَبِّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى، قَالَ: إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الْحَسَنَاتِ وَالسَّيِّئَاتِ، ثُمَّ بَيَّنَ ذَلِكَ، فَمَنْ هَمَّ بِحَسَنَةٍ فَلَمْ يَعْمَلْهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ حَسَنَةً كَامِلَةً، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِهَا فَعَمِلَهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ عَشْرَ حَسَنَاتٍ إِلَى سَبْعِمِائَةِ ضِعْفٍ إِلَى أَضْعَافٍ كَثِيرَةٍ، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِسَيِّئَةٍ فَلَمْ يَعْمَلْهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ حَسَنَةً كَامِلَةً، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِهَا فَعَمِلَهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ سَيِّئَةً وَاحِدَةً.، في صحيحيهما بهذه الحروف

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ, narrating from his Lord, said: "Allah has written good deeds and bad deeds, then made that clear. Whoever intends a good deed and does not do it, Allah writes it with Him as a complete good deed. If he intends it and does it, Allah writes it with Him as ten good deeds, up to seven hundred times, up to many times more. Whoever intends a bad deed and does not do it, Allah writes it with Him as a complete good deed. If he intends it and does it, Allah writes it as one bad deed."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās. Al-Bukhārī (6491) and Muslim (131).

- Allah's generosity: a good intention alone is rewarded.
- Good deeds are multiplied ten to seven hundred times and more.
- Leaving a sin for Allah's sake is rewarded as a good deed.

Ḥadīth 38 · The friends of Allah

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى قَالَ: مَنْ عَادَى لِي وَلِيًّا فَقَدْ آذَنْتُهُ بِالْحَرْبِ، وَمَا تَقَرَّبَ إِلَيَّ عَبْدِي بِشَيْءٍ أَحَبَّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا افْتَرَضْتُهُ عَلَيْهِ، وَلَا يَزَالُ عَبْدِي يَتَقَرَّبُ إِلَيَّ بِالنَّوَافِلِ حَتَّى أُحِبَّهُ، فَإِذَا أَحْبَبْتُهُ كُنْتُ سَمْعَهُ الَّذِي يَسْمَعُ بِهِ، وَبَصَرَهُ الَّذِي يُبْصِرُ بِهِ، وَيَدَهُ الَّتِي يَبْطِشُ بِهَا، وَرِجْلَهُ الَّتِي يَمْشِي بِهَا، وَلَئِنْ سَأَلَنِي لَأُعْطِيَنَّهُ، وَلَئِنْ اسْتَعَاذَنِي لَأُعِيذَنَّهُ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Allah the Exalted said: Whoever shows enmity to a friend of Mine, I have declared war on him. My servant does not draw near to Me with anything more beloved to Me than what I have made obligatory on him. And My servant keeps drawing near to Me with voluntary deeds until I love him. When I love him, I become his hearing with which he hears, his sight with which he sees, his hand with which he strikes and his foot with which he walks. If he asks Me, I will surely give him, and if he seeks refuge with Me, I will surely protect him.”

Narrated by Abū Hurayrah. Al-Bukhārī (6502).

- The friends of Allah (awliyāʾ) are the believers who fear Him; harming them is very serious.
- Obligations are the most beloved way to draw near to Allah; start there.
- Voluntary deeds after the obligations bring Allah’s love.

Ḥadīth 39 · Mistakes, forgetfulness and coercion

عَنْ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَجَاوَزَ لِي عَنْ أُمَّتِي الْخَطَأَ وَالنِّسْيَانَ وَمَا اسْتُكْرِهُوا عَلَيْهِ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: “Allah has pardoned my nation for me their mistakes, their forgetfulness and what they are forced to do.”

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās. Ibn Mājah (2045) and al-Bayhaqī; graded ḥasan by an-Nawawī.

- A person is not sinful for genuine mistakes, forgetfulness or real coercion.
- This shows the ease of the Sharīʿah and Allah’s mercy to this nation.
- Some worldly consequences may remain, such as repaying damaged property or making up a missed prayer.

Ḥadīth 40 · Be in this world like a stranger

عَنْ ابْنِ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: أَخَذَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ بِمَنْكِبِي، وَقَالَ: كُنْ فِي الدُّنْيَا كَأَنَّك غَرِيبٌ أَوْ عَابِرُ سَبِيلٍ. وَكَانَ ابْنُ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا يَقُولُ: إذَا أَمْسَيْتَ فَلَا تَنْتَظِرْ الصَّبَاحَ، وَإِذَا أَصْبَحْتَ فَلَا تَنْتَظِرْ الْمَسَاءَ، وَخُذْ مِنْ صِحَّتِك لِمَرَضِك، وَمِنْ حَيَاتِك لِمَوْتِك

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ took hold of my shoulder and said: "Be in this world as though you were a stranger or a traveller passing through." And Ibn ʿUmar used to say: "When evening comes, do not wait for the morning; and when morning comes, do not wait for the evening. Take from your health for your sickness, and from your life for your death."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar. Al-Bukhārī (6416).

- A stranger does not settle or compete for status; a traveller only takes what he needs for the journey.
- The Prophet ﷺ taught with touch and closeness: he held Ibn ʿUmar's shoulder.
- Do good now; do not delay to a tomorrow that may not come.

Ḥadīth 41 · Desires that follow the Revelation

عَنْ أَبِي مُحَمَّدٍ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَمْرِو بْنِ الْعَاصِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا، قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يَكُونَ هَوَاهُ تَبَعًا لِمَا جِئْتُ بِهِ

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "None of you truly believes until his desires follow what I have brought."

Narrated by ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAmr ibn al-ʿĀṣ. An-Nawawī said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ, narrated in Kitāb al-Ḥujjah. Several later scholars, such as Ibn Rajab, judged its chain weak; its meaning is supported by the Qur'an (an-Nisāʾ 4:65).

- Complete faith means bringing your wishes in line with the Qur'an and Sunnah.
- A believer does not pick only the rulings he likes.
- Its meaning is confirmed by the Qur'an: "No, by your Lord, they will not believe until they make you judge in what they dispute" (an-Nisāʾ 4:65).

عَنْ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْت رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ! إِنَّكَ مَا دَعَوْتَنِي وَرَجَوْتَنِي غَفَرْتُ لَك عَلَى مَا كَانَ مِنْك وَلَا أُبَالِي، يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ! لَوْ بَلَغَتْ ذُنُوبُك عَنَانَ السَّمَاءِ ثُمَّ اسْتَغْفَرْتنِي غَفَرْتُ لَك، يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ! إنَّك لَوْ أَتَيْتنِي بِقُرَابِ الْأَرْضِ خَطَايَا ثُمَّ لَقِيتنِي لَا تُشْرِكُ بِي شَيْئًا لَأَتَيْتُك بِقُرَابِهَا مَغْفِرَةً

I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: “Allah the Exalted said: O son of Ādam, as long as you call on Me and hope in Me, I will forgive you for what you have done, and I do not mind. O son of Ādam, if your sins reached the clouds of the sky and then you asked Me for forgiveness, I would forgive you. O son of Ādam, if you came to Me with sins nearly filling the earth and then met Me not associating anything with Me, I would come to you with forgiveness nearly filling it.”

Narrated by Anas ibn Mālik. At-Tirmidhī (3540), who said: ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ.

- Three keys to forgiveness: duʿāʾ with hope, seeking forgiveness (istighfār), and tawḥīd.
- No sin is too big for Allah’s forgiveness when a person turns back to Him.
- Shirk is the one sin that blocks this forgiveness if a person dies on it.

Tracker My memorisation tracker

Tick each ḥadīth when you can recite it from memory. Ask a teacher or parent to sign.

No.	Done	Signed	No.	Done	Signed
1	☐		22	☐	
2	☐		23	☐	
3	☐		24	☐	
4	☐		25	☐	
5	☐		26	☐	
6	☐		27	☐	
7	☐		28	☐	
8	☐		29	☐	
9	☐		30	☐	
10	☐		31	☐	
11	☐		32	☐	
12	☐		33	☐	
13	☐		34	☐	
14	☐		35	☐	
15	☐		36	☐	
16	☐		37	☐	
17	☐		38	☐	
18	☐		39	☐	
19	☐		40	☐	
20	☐		41	☐	
21	☐		42	☐	

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. Who compiled the Forty Ḥadīth?

a) Imām Mālik b) Imām an-Nawawī c) Imām al-Bukhārī d) Ibn Kathīr

2. "Actions are only by…"

a) Their results b) Their size c) Intentions d) Their difficulty

3. In the ḥadīth of Jibrīl, iḥsān is:

a) To worship Allah as though you see Him b) To give charity c) To fast often d) To read the Qur'an

4. "The religion is…"

a) Ease b) Sincere advice (naṣīḥah) c) Knowledge d) Patience

5. "Part of the excellence of a person's Islām is…"

a) Praying at night b) Giving much charity c) Leaving what does not concern him d) Fasting Mondays

6. The Prophet ﷺ told the man who asked for advice three times:

a) Do not become angry b) Pray at night c) Honour your parents d) Seek knowledge

7. "Be mindful of Allah, and He will…"

a) Make you rich b) Protect you c) Give you children d) Answer every wish

8. "Purity is…"

a) Half of faith b) All of faith c) A sunnah d) For the prayer only

9. "There should be neither harm nor…"

a) Anger b) Debt c) Reciprocating harm d) Jealousy

10. "Be in this world as though you were…"

a) A king b) A stranger or a traveller c) A student d) A guest of honour

11. Whoever sees a wrong should change it with his hand, then his tongue, then:

a) His wealth b) His family c) His heart d) His teacher

12. The last ḥadīth in the collection is about:

a) The vastness of Allah's forgiveness b) Fasting c) Zakāh d) The night prayer

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	b) An-Nawawī	7	b) Protect you
2	c) Intentions	8	a) Half of faith
3	a) As though you see Him	9	c) Reciprocating harm
4	b) Sincere advice	10	b) A stranger or a traveller
5	c) Leaving what does not concern him	11	c) His heart
6	a) Do not become angry	12	a) Allah's forgiveness

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وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

“And my success is only through Allah.” (Hūd 11:88)

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